



US Army Combined Arms Center
DRIVE CHANGE...FORGE VICTORY!

Army Credentialing Assistance



Educate to Win!

**The Army Credentialing Assistance Program Office (ACAPO),
Army Credentialing and Continuing Education Services for Soldiers
(ACCESS), The Army University, Ft Knox, KY**



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**Army Credentialing Assistance
(CA) Program**



ARMYIGNITED

What is Army CA?



ARMY CREDENTIALING
ASSISTANCE



What is Credentialing Assistance (CA)?

Much like the Army's Tuition Assistance (TA) funding, which is provided to eligible Soldiers working towards an academic degree, CA funds allows Soldiers to pursue voluntary credentials.

CA is a voluntary, off-duty program that directly contributes to improving Total Army readiness, supporting Soldiers' professional development, retaining quality Soldiers, and preparing Soldiers for meaningful employment upon transition from military service.



ARMY CREDENTIALING
ASSISTANCE



Army Credentialing Assistance Program:

Program that supports the use of funding to obtain industry recognized credentials



Army COOL (Credentialing Opportunities On-Line): Repository for all credentials Soldiers are authorized to pursue (Library)

<https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/index.html>



Academic Institution (AI) Portal:

Platform for Vendors to add courses/exams/books/materials

<https://aiportal.us.af.mil/>



ArmyIgnitED:

Platform for where Soldiers will submit their CA Requests

<https://www.armyignited.army.mil/>

**All training providers, colleges, universities, and credentialing agencies
will be referred to as “Vendors”**



- Soldiers may receive up to \$2000 per fiscal year toward any credential listed in Army COOL (some aviation licenses may only receive up to \$1000)
- The credential does **NOT** have to align to the Soldier's MOS/ASI
- The funding may fund training, books, materials, exams, recertifications, fees
- Training can be provided in person, online, hybrid, credit bearing/noncredit bearing courses/bootcamps
- All Active Duty, ARNG and USAR Soldiers may be eligible to request funding
- More details are provided when vendor is approved for the CA Program



- Soldiers navigate through Army COOL to search for credentials they wish to pursue
- Soldiers will submit CA Requests in ArmyIgnitED. Once submitted, the Army Credentialing Assistance Program Office (ACAPO) will review it
- Soldier are instructed to contact vendors to request a custom quote and secure seat for course if possible. Please provide information on required materials, books, fees, training dates without requiring payment
- All Soldiers are REQUIRED to upload a quote that matches what vendors list in the AI Portal
- **NOTE! the quote must have Soldier's name, start and end date of course (if there is a set timeframe), all items they will receive, the total cost (TO INCLUDE SHIPPING, if applicable), and must have the vendor company name (can be an email with all details)**
- When payment and receipts are received and reconciled, the Soldier will be informed they can begin by CA Finance



- **NOTE!! Soldiers are NOT allowed to start a course before payment, or they will be liable for the total cost of the course**
- Before creating an account in the AI Portal, it is important to have the following mandatory items:
- CAGE Code- this must be obtained from SAM.GOV. We are not associated with SAM.GOV so any questions on this must be addressed to them.
- You must be in business at least for 2 years

If you do not have the above, you will not be able to participate in the CA program. There are other requirements when you complete the application, but the above 2 items take the longest to obtain.



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New Vendor Process



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➤ Soldiers who recommend vendors to participate will be sent an email with information on the CA Program

FW: The Army Credentialing Assistance Program Invitational Message- AI Portal -Updated Message

Reply Reply All Forward ...
Wed 2/21/2024 7:41 AM



You forwarded this message on 4/18/2024 1:27 PM.

Army CA Vendor Process Guide 2.0 22 Nov 22.pdf .pdf File	CAGE Code- Quick_Guide_to_Providing_Ownership_Details.pdf .pdf File	Vendor requirements for application vs1_5July23.docx .docx File
CA MOA Vendors Final 22 Aug 23.pdf .pdf File		

Greetings,

The Army has a new program to assist Soldiers in pursuing credentials/licensures/certifications called The Army Credentialing Assistance (CA) Program. CA can potentially fund training that leads to the credential / licensure / certification, books, fees, exams, and even recertification (if applicable). Soldiers can use both CA and TA simultaneously. Additional information is also attached that will assist you with any questions you may have regarding the application process or the CA program.

REVIEW AND RETURN THE ATTACHED MEMORANDUM OF AGREEMENT (MOA) TO THE ACAPO TEAM PRIOR TO STARTING THE AI PORTAL APPLICATION! MAKE SURE THAT IT IS SIGNED BY A MEMBER OF YOUR COMPANY'S LEADERSHIP, I.E. THE CEO, OWNER, PRESIDENT.

Currently, Soldiers are trying to pursue credentials with your company. They cannot request funding for this training until your company is listed as an approved vendor in the ArmyIgnitED system.

Thanks to their recommendation, we are excited to extend our invitation to you to join the Army Credentialing Assistance Program. Once you have requested your personal account through the Academic Institution (AI) Portal, and it has been approved by the Army Credentialing Assistance Program Office, (ACAPO), you will be able to begin providing your information for courses to review and select.

*First thing first.... Please review the attached slides for creating your account and the requirements that are required to register.

*Next, confirm your credential or license is listed and approved on the Army COOL webpage, at <https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/index.htm>

If the credential is not listed on the Army COOL page, you may request the credential be added by selecting, MENU, CONTACT US, and then selecting RECOMMEND CREDENTIALS. (Please note that the approval process ranges from a few weeks to a few months based on the fact finding required to verify the credential.)

Should your organization be approved, CA funding is remunerated prior to the start of the course or exam by government credit card (government purchase card). Our finance team will contact you to do this. Soldiers MUST contact you requesting information regarding a specific program you may offer as it is part of their process for requesting funding.

They are instructed to request a quote that MUST match what you have listed in ArmyIgnitED. They are also instructed NOT to pay anything out of pocket as they will NOT be reimbursed. Additionally, they are not allowed to start early with your _____



- Vendors must agree to terms and conditions of the Program (an MOA will be attached to the email)

MEMORANDUM OF AGREEMENT BETWEEN
HEADQUARTERS, DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY,
AND

YOUR VENDOR NAME HERE!

SUBJECT: Credentialing Assistance Program

1. Preamble:

a. Providing access to quality credentialing opportunities is a strategic investment that enhances a Soldier's ability to support mission accomplishment and successfully return to civilian life. A forward-leaning, lifelong learning environment is fundamental to the maintenance of a mentally powerful and adaptive leadership ready force. Today's fast-paced and highly mobile environment, where frequent deployments and mobilizations



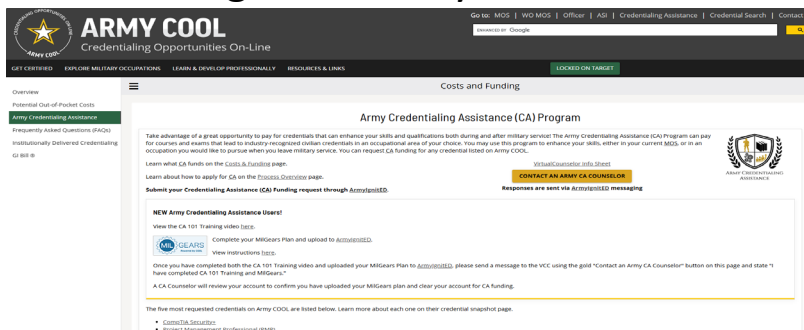
Key Points:

- Fill out the top paragraph with your vendor's name
- Read the entire MOA!
- Understand that it was written at a high level for approval...Questions, Ask!
- Print and Sign at the bottom of the document
- Include Title of Signatory (i.e. President, Vice President, COO, etc.), and Agency Name
- ****DO NOT USE DOCUSIGN!**

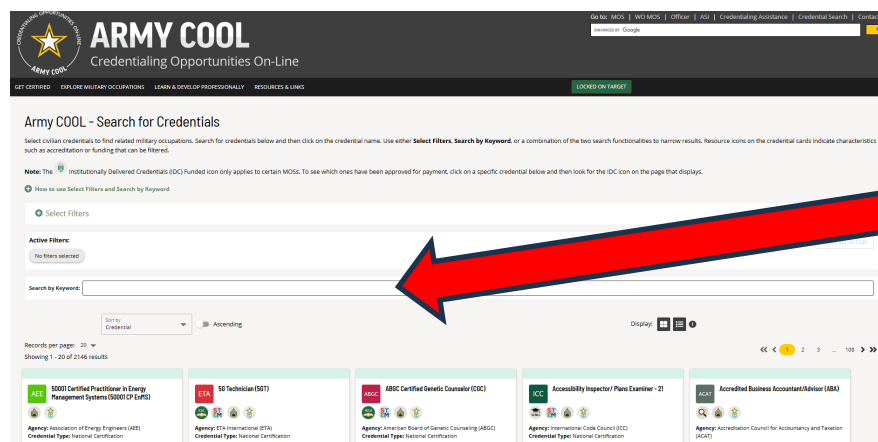


Go to Army COOL <https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/index.html> and then select:

- Credentialing Assistance Program Tab if you would like information on the CA Program



- Confirm you offer training/exam towards a credential listed in Army COOL: <https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/credsearch/index.html>



Type in "Search by Keyword" to find specific credentials



After profile is created (upcoming slides), some important items to have ready for your application:

- Business License or Air Agency Certificate (You are authorized to do business in your state)
Note!! If you are an Academic Institution and DoD MOU approved, your current MOU can be inserted instead of the Business License
- Credentialing Body (CB) Authorization Letter (stating your organization is an Authorized Provider)
- If you do not have a CB letter, you must provide Training Statistics (at least 25 students per credential you offer training or exams for)
- Website URL (on a word document! Must be your company's URL linking to the course/exam offering)
- Course Cost List (name of the course, the credential it aligns to in Army COOL, and the total cost)
- Cage Code

(If documents don't load, 1st make sure they are saved as a PDF and that they are no larger than 4 MB! If you are still having issues, contact the helpdesk)



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AI Portal



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AI Portal



<https://aiportal.us.af.mil/>



AIPORTAL
Academic Institution Portal

Sign in with  **LOGIN.GOV**

Don't have a user account?  [Sign up](#)

New institution?  [Apply for an institution account](#)

Don't have Login.gov?  [Create Login.gov account](#) | [FAQ](#)

[Contact your User Account Controller](#)



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AI Portal cont.

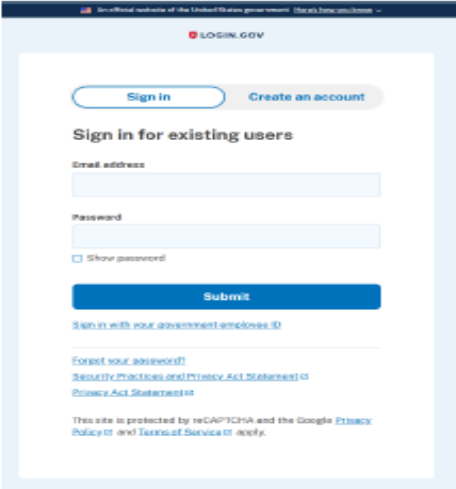


Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

When you visit <https://aiportal.army.mil>, you will be prompted to login with Login.gov. You will need to either create an account or sign in using your existing Login.gov account.

Sign in with  LOGIN.GOV

Enter email and password > click 'Submit.'



The screenshot shows the official Login.gov website. At the top, it says "Official website of the United States government" and "Secure, fast, and reliable". Below this is the "LOGIN.GOV" header. There are two buttons: "Sign in" (highlighted) and "Create an account". Under "Sign in for existing users", there are input fields for "Email address" and "Password". A checkbox labeled "Show password" is below the password field. A blue "Submit" button is at the bottom of the form. Below the button, there are links for "Sign in with your government employee ID", "Forgot your password?", "Security Practices and Privacy Act Statement", and "Privacy Act Statement". At the very bottom, a small disclaimer states: "This site is protected by reCAPTCHA and the Google Privacy Policy and Terms of Service apply."

On your initial visit to the site, you will need to verify your identity using either the Okta Verify app or by visiting a United States Post Office.

The Okta Verify app is a free application. The Pro version is NOT REQUIRED. Below is the logo you should look for when downloading it to your mobile device.





Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

You will select **'Continue'** in the process online using Okta Verify.

Let's verify your identity for Air Force Identity Management Solution (Okta.mil)

Air Force Identity Management Solution (Okta.mil) needs to make sure you are you — not someone pretending to be you.
[Learn more about verifying your identity](#)

You'll need to:

- 1 **Have a driver's license or state ID**
Other forms of ID are not accepted. We'll check that you are the person on your ID.
- 2 **Enter your Social Security number**
You will not need your physical SSN card.
- 3 **Match to your phone number**
We match your phone number with your personal information and send a one-time code to your phone.
- 4 **Re-enter your Login.gov password**
Your password saves and encrypts your personal information.

Continue

Check the box and click **'Continue.'**

How verifying your identity works

Identity verification happens in two parts:

Verify your identity

We'll ask for your ID, phone number, and other personal information to verify your identity against public records.

Secure your account

We'll encrypt your account when you re-enter your password. Encryption means your data is protected and only you will be able to access or change your information.

☐ By checking this box, you are letting Login.gov ask for, use, keep, and share your personal information. We will use it to verify your identity.

[Learn more about our privacy and security measures](#)

Continue



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

You can verify your identity online or at a United States Post Office. If you select 'Continue Online,' you will be provided with a link to your phone number. If you select 'Continue in Person,' you will need to visit your local post office to verify your identity.

Verify your identity online

You'll take photos of your ID to verify your identity fully online. Most users finish this process in one sitting.

This option is better if you have a phone to take photos of your ID.

Continue online

Verify your identity at a Post Office

You'll enter your ID information online, and verify your identity in person at a participating Post Office.

This option is better if you don't have a phone to take photos of your ID.

Continue in person



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

Enter the phone number to which you would like for a link to be sent to upload your documents.
Click 'Send Link.'

LOGIN.GOV

Getting started Verify your ID Verify your information Verify your phone number Re-enter your password

How would you like to add your ID?

We'll collect information about you by reading your state-issued ID.

Recommended

Use your phone to take photos

You won't have to sign in again, and you'll switch back to this computer after you take photos. Your mobile phone must have a camera and a web browser.

Phone number

[Redacted phone number]

Send link

You will see confirmation that the link was sent to the number entered.

LOGIN.GOV

Getting started Verify your ID Verify your information Verify your phone number Re-enter your password

Do not close this window.
The next step will load automatically.

We sent a message to your phone

You entered [Redacted phone number]

Please check your phone and follow instructions to take a photo of your state-issued ID.

[Back](#)

At this point, you will need to follow the directions on your mobile device from the OKTA app to verify your identity. You will need to take a picture of the front and back of your driver's license. You can do this from the OKTA app, select the TAKE PICTURE link or you can take



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

the pictures prior to opening the app and then choose the UPLOAD FILE option. Your pictures must be CLEAR. Users have reported putting your camera in portrait mode helps to get a clear picture. OKTA only allows so many attempts to get your driver's license uploaded to their app. Too many unsuccessful attempts and the site will force you to your local post office to verify your identity.

Once your identity has been verified, you will be directed back to the website where you began your initial account set up.

Next steps after you have verified your identity:

Enter your SSN and click 'Continue.'

LOGIN.GOV

Getting started Verify your ID **Verify your information** Verify your phone number Re-enter your password

Enter your Social Security number

We need your Social Security number to verify your name, date of birth and address. [Learn more about how we protect your sensitive information](#)

Don't have a Social Security number?

You must have a Social Security number to finish verifying your identity. [Exit Login.gov and return to Air Force Identity Management Solution \(Okta.mil\)](#)

Social Security number
Example: 123-45-6789

***** I

☐ Show Social Security number

Continue



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

Verify the information and click 'Submit.'

Verify your information

We read your information from your ID. Review it and make any updates before submitting for verification.

First name: [redacted]
Last name: [redacted]
Date of birth: [redacted]
ID number: [redacted]
Address line 1: [redacted] [Update](#)
Address line 2: [redacted]
City: [redacted]
State: [redacted]
ZIP Code: [redacted]
Social Security number: [redacted] [Update](#)
☐ Show Social Security number

Submit

Enter your phone number and click 'Send Code.'

LOGIN.GOV

Getting started | Verify your ID | Verify your information | **Verify your phone number** | Enter your password

We verified your information

Verify your phone number

We'll check your number with records and send you a one-time code to verify your identity.

Enter a phone number that is:

- Based in the United States
- Your primary number (the one you use the most often)

[Learn more about what phone number to use](#)

Phone number: [redacted]

If you entered a landline above, please select "Phone call" below.

☒ Text message (SMS) ☐ Phone call

Send code



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

Enter the code sent to your mobile device and click 'Submit.'

Re-enter your Login.gov password and click 'Continue.'



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AI Portal cont.



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

You will be provided with a personal key. Save this information by clicking 'Download.'

Verify that you have saved your personal key and click 'Continue.'



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

Verify that your information has been entered correctly. Click 'Agree & Continue.'

**Connect your verified information
to Air Force Identity Management
Solution (Okta.mil)**

We'll share this information with Air Force Identity
Management Solution (Okta.mil):

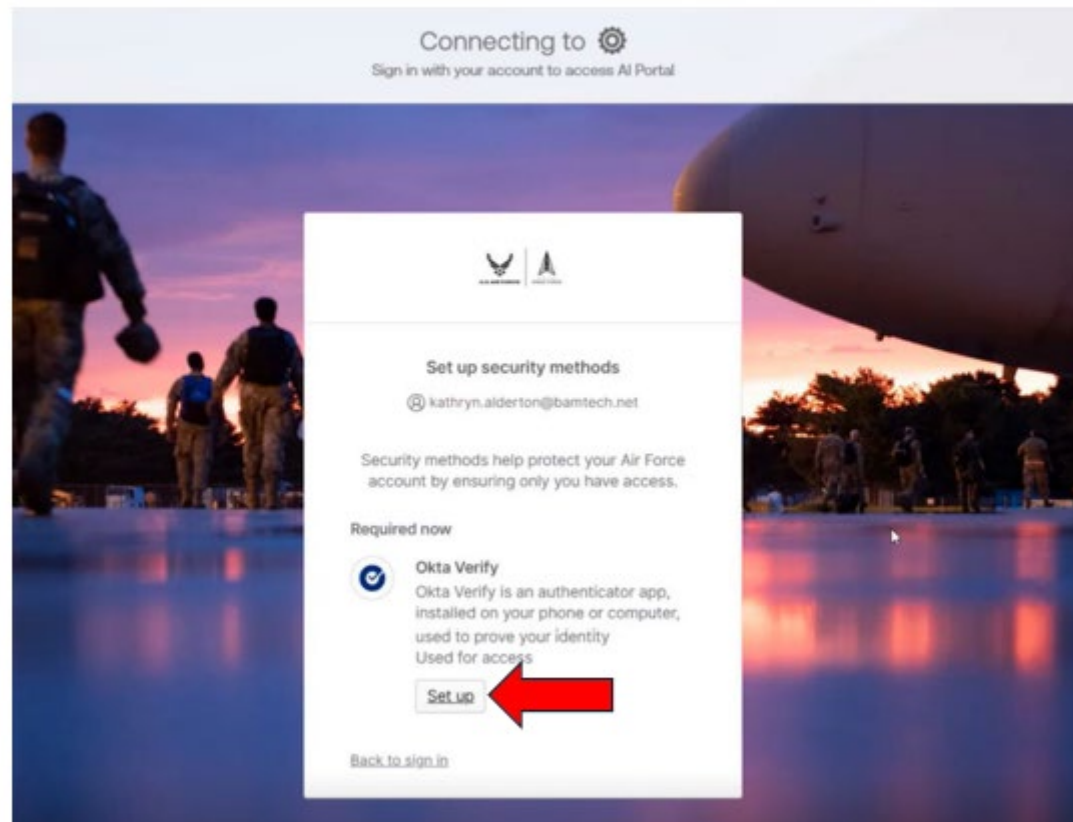
- ✓ Email address
- ✓ Full name
- ✓ Address
- ✓ Phone number
- ✓ Date of birth
- ✓ Social Security number
- ✓ PIV/CAC Identity
- ✓ Updated on
February 21, 2025 at 4:47 PM

Agree and continue



Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

You will then be prompted to move forward within the Okta Verify App. Click 'Set up.'





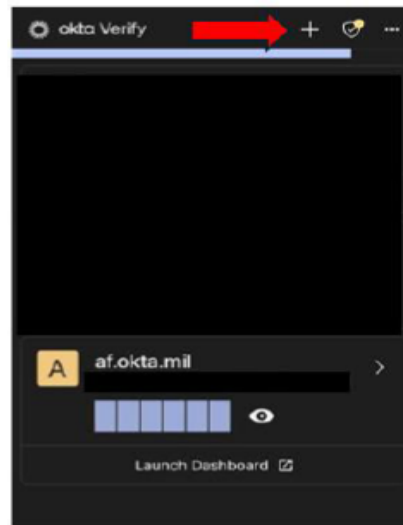
Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

In the OKTA Verify App:

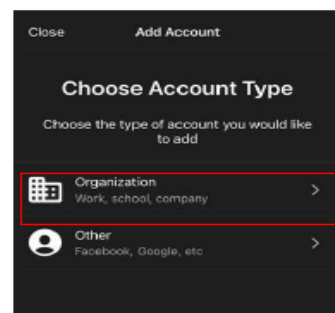
Once you see the option to set up your Okta Verify, you will need to open the app on your mobile device and ensure that the organization has been added.

To add the organization:

1. Select the '+' icon



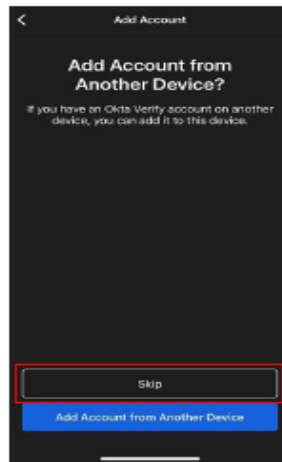
2. Select 'Organization.'



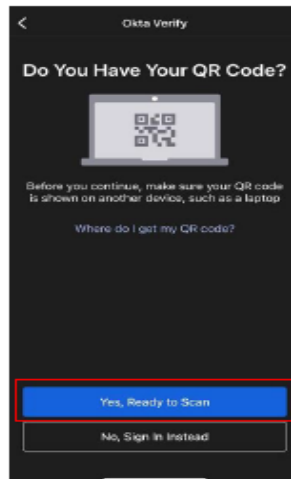


Login.gov and OKTA Tutorial

3. Select 'Skip.'



4. If you see the QR Code on your computer screen, select 'Yes, ready to scan.'



5. Scan the QR code you see on your screen.



Recommendations when setting up your Login.gov account.

1. If you have a login.gov account, consider creating a separate one for your .edu email to avoid issues with Okta. Users who add their .edu email to an existing login.gov account may face problems registering with Okta. If Okta shows your personal email, delete your Okta account, remove your .edu from login.gov, and create a new login.gov account for your .edu email.

2. If you're having trouble adding your driver's license pictures to your login.gov account, here are some steps you can take:

- **Use a High-Resolution Camera:** Use a smartphone or tablet camera instead of a webcam for better quality images.
- **Proper Background:** Place your ID on a solid, dark background to avoid distractions.
- **Good Lighting:** Take photos in a well-lit area with indirect light to avoid glare and shadows.
- **Steady Your Device:** Hold your device still while taking the photos. Propping your arms on a table can help.
- **Check the ID:** Ensure the ID barcodes are not damaged or dirty.



- Full ID in Frame: Make sure the entire ID is visible in the photo.
- Upload Existing Photos: If you have existing photos of your ID, you can upload them instead of taking new ones, provided you don't also need to add a photo of your face

3. If you receive an error stating your phone number didn't match the one on file:

Your name must be on the phone bill for the phone number you use. If not, you cannot verify or create an account online. You must verify by mail. Select verify by mail option. Login.gov will send a letter within 5-7 business days. You have 30 days to use the 10-digit code provided in the letter to create/verify your account. You must know your email address and password. The letter provides instructions on what to do.

4. If the system can't verify your email or phone number: If you know your email and phone but it can't be verified by the system, you can request a delete and reactivation of them. Login to login.gov and search on delete account. They will delete your email, password, and phone number associated with account. This takes 24 hours to do, you will receive 2 emails one immediately and the other 24 hours later. You can reuse the email after 24 hours and upon receipt of second email with instructions.



Additional Login.gov questions can be found by visiting the links below:

<https://www.login.gov/what-is-login/>

<https://www.login.gov/help/get-started/create-your-account/>

<https://www.login.gov/help/get-started/authentication-methods/>

<https://www.login.gov/help/trouble-signing-in/how-to-sign-in/>

<https://www.login.gov/help/trouble-signing-in/forgot-your-password/>

<https://www.login.gov/help/trouble-signing-in/face-or-touch-unlock/>

<https://www.login.gov/help/manage-your-account/change-your-password/>

<https://www.login.gov/help/manage-your-account/delete-your-account/>

What you will need to verify your identity:

<https://www.login.gov/help/verify-your-identity/overview/>



- Questions? Send emails to: usarmy.knox.tradoc.mbx.armyu-access-credentialing-assistance@army.mil
- To locate the list of credentials:
<https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/index.htm>
- Credentialing Assistance Page in Army COOL:
https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/costs_and_funding/army_credential_assistance.htm
- Commercial And Government Entity Code (CAGE) Code- <https://sam.gov>
- Link to AI Portal : <https://aiportal.us.af.mil/>

Help Desk Schedule
0900-1800, EST/0800-1700, CST
Help Desk Contact Information Phone:
(276) 231-0938



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Questions?

usarmy.knox.tradoc.mbx.armyu-access-credentialing-assistance@army.mil



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